

TAMBARAM

Chromepet » Pallavaram » Tambaram West » Rajakilpakkam » Mannivakkam » Guindy » Keelkattalai » Nanganallur » Guduvanchery » Hasthinapuram » Pammal » Tambaram East

Medavakkam » Srinivasa Nagar » Kathipara Junction » Kovilambakkam » Sadasivam Nagar » Potheri » Selaiyur » Sembakkam » St.Thomas Mount » Madipakkam » Urappakkam » Paranur

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

V. Santhanam, a veteran social activist and a resident of Chromepet, has been in the forefront of campaigns against encroachments on Rajendra Prasad (RP) Road, Chromepet - Hasthinapuram, and regulating traffic at RP Road and Chitlapakkam Main Road.

On February 7, the septuagenarian became a victim of the wrong direction driving near the same road. He met with an accident on the MIT flyover in Chromepet, which has left him with a heavily injured back.

Santhanam, who was on his way to Nehru Nagar on a two-wheeler, took the flyover through the service lane along The New Colony when a motorcyclist hit him from behind.

"The motorcyclist should not have taken the flyover; he should have taken GST Road instead," says Santhanam, who is recuperating

from the back injury at home.

Many accidents have occurred on the overpass in the past.

A fatal stretch

Years ago, a schoolgirl on a bicycle, on her way home after attending the Independence Day ceremony, was fatally knocked down by an MTC bus on RP Road.

No action was taken except for the removal of an encroachment by a commercial establishment at the junction. Within a few days, the establishment again extended its boundaries.

From the flyover to the end of RP Road, there is no traffic regulation, even on the opposite lane towards Pallavaram. On RP Road,

there are no safety measures such as traffic signals or zebra crossings. The road is marked by petrol bunks, marriage halls, schools, banks and many commercial other establishments.

The traffic police booth on the flyover is usually deserted.

"Boards should be placed below the flyover, indicating that the overpass is for vehicles heading towards Chitlapakkam, Hasthinapuram and Chromepet East. Motorists heading towards Pallavaram and Tambaram Sanatorium should go through GST Road, which is something I have been asking for, for years," he adds.

'You could be next'

Wrong direction driving by a motorcyclist on MIT flyover in Chromepet leaves civic activist V. Santhanam with an injured back

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Chromepet terminus *gets a facelift*

Tamparam Corporation replaces wornout roof sheets; activists question need for large terminus on arterial stretch

T. ARVIND

Renovation of the Chromepet bus terminus on GST Road is under way, with the Tamparam Corporation taking up replacement of the ageing roof sheets and related works. While commuters welcome the long-pending facelift, some residents and activists have questioned whether the large terminus is necessary on a busy arterial road.

The bus terminus, located in Ward 28, serves as a key transit point for Metropolitan Transport Corporation (MTC) buses operating between the southern suburbs and various parts of Greater Chennai. Officials said the structure, built nearly 18 years ago using MPLAD funds of former Union Minister and MP T.R. Baalu, had deteriorated over time.

An allocation of ₹25 lakh has been made for the renovation. Officials said the damaged roof sheets were being completely replaced to



Chromepet bus terminus. PHOTO: T. ARVIND

improve commuter safety and comfort.

Demand for rationalisation

Despite the improvements, some residents have raised concerns about the utilisation of space. Senior social activist V. Santhanam said the civic body could consider converting the terminus into a simpler bus shelter.

“There are no cut services originating from Chromepet. Maintaining such a large structure is costly and it occupies a substantial por-

tion of the road,” he said. A cantilevered bus shelter, similar to the one on the eastern side towards Tambaram, would suffice, he added.

Commuters also pointed to poor bus regulation within the terminus. Although bays have been earmarked for different destinations, buses often halt near the entrance instead of moving to designated spots.

“If the first bus stops at the entrance, others queue up behind it, forcing us to run to board,” said

Kausalya, a regular commuter. Srinivasan, another commuter, said buses should halt strictly at their marked bays to avoid confusion and congestion.

Mr. Santhanam said bus pile-ups sometimes extend up to the traffic signal near the police booth. With vehicles taking U-turns near the Radha Nagar subway, traffic movement becomes further constrained, he noted. Rationalising the structure could free up space for smoother vehicular flow, he added.

Corporation's response

Tamparam Corporation Commissioner S. Balachandran said a coordination meeting with officials of the MTC and TNSC would be convened to improve regulation and ensure commuter-friendly operations.

He also cited the “Tamparam model” of bus terminus redevelopment, where excess pavements were removed to optimise space. A similar approach could be examined for Chromepet, he said.

Direct motorists to take Medavakkam flyover'

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Motorists negotiating Madambakkam Main Road and Velachery Main Road have appealed to the Tamparam Police Commissionerate and the State Highways Department to install boards that direct motorists to not approach the junction to reach Vijayanagaram.

The motorists should take a right turn at Classical Language Road and Velachery Main Road and ascend the flyover.

Motorists are under the notion that Velachery Main Road can be used to reach Gowrivakkam, ever since Velachery Main Road, along Madambakkam Main Road, was opened to traffic.

S. Sairam, a motorist, says, “When entering Madambakkam Main Road from Vijayanagaram, the traffic gets disrupted. We are forced to slam on the brakes, which can lead to collisions. The



Wrong side driving is rife at Velachery Main Road and Madambakkam Main Road.

danger is more when heavy vehicles from Vijaya Nagaram enter Madambakkam Main Road.”

To make the situation worse, motorists from the western lane of Velachery Main Road (towards Pallikaranai) negotiate the junction to go to Patel Street, Vimala Nagar and Munusamy Nagar.

Similarly, their counterparts on the eastern lane avoid ascending the flyover to go to Bhel Nagar,

United Colony, Sriram Nagar, Siddharth Nagar, Shanthi Avenue, Parasuram Avenue, Baktha Reddy Avenue, Pushpa Nagar and Kamaraj Garden.

E. Sakunthala, a motorist, says, “Motorists come from all directions and bring the traffic to a grinding halt.”

More personnel should be deployed to bring the situation under control, say motorists.

READERS WRITE

‘Levy nominal charges at crematorium’



Chromepet crematorium along the MIT Flyover and (below) Bharathipuram burial ground.

S. SRIMATHY

The liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) crematorium in Chromepet, near Madras Institute of Technology flyover, has been charging exorbitant fees for cremations.

Some months ago, it was ₹1500; now it has been increased to ₹ 2500. Residents cannot understand how Tambaram City Municipal Corporation (TCMC) permitted this, considering that a majority of the Greater Chennai Corporation crematoriums (both electric and gasifier) offer free cremation.

The same should also be followed at the cremation grounds and burial sites under TCMC or nominal charges should be levied. There are three additional gasifier crematoriums at Pallavaram, Pammal and Hasthinapuram, and rates vary.

Furthermore, TCMC should consider revamping the sprawling burial ground at Bharathipuram in Chromepet (East), which is poorly maintained.



The premises are overgrown with bushes and litter. There are no shelters or seating areas; and no space to perform the rituals. Senior citizens suffer the most. Snakes are frequently sighted.

Even the name board at the entrance needs to be replaced.

S. Srimathy is a resident of Chromepet

Alternative treatment camp today

Nesamani Nagar Residents' Welfare Association in Perumbakkam is conducting a free alternative treatment camp on February 22. Lajpat Rai Mehra Neurotherapy (LMNT), Sujok therapy, acupuncture, and holistic healing (without medicines), electro homeopathy and Bach flower medicines will be some of the highlights at the camp, said a release. The camp will be held from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. at Plot Number: 19, First Street, Nesamani Nagar.

For details, contact N. K. Raja, the association president, and Shantalakshmi, a LMNT neurotherapist at 91764 53025 and 98408 53941.

You can be our volunteer writer

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number

A dangerously elevated manhole in Medavakkam

It is located on the arterial Tambaram Velachery Main Road



R. RAVINDRAN

There is a plethora of challenges for motorists to tackle on the roads without a mound of manhole entering the grim-framed picture.

On the section of Tambaram Velachery Main Road

that meets Semmozhi Salai in Medavakkam, motorists have to deal with this additional challenge: a manhole that is too high for their safety.

Poor lighting on this section of Tambaram Velachery Main Road magnifies the danger from this mon-

strously elevated manhole. The traffic police personnel regulating this section try to defuse the threat in their own jugaad way, making use of a prop at their disposal. They place a barricade on the manhole to warn motorists about its presence.



The manhole on the section of Tambaram Velachery Main Road that meets Semmozhi Salai in Medavakkam. The image was taken on February 20. PHOTOS : R RAVINDRAN

RWA celebrates its 35th annual day

The 35th Annual Day of Chitlapakkam Muthulakshmi Nagar Welfare Association was held recently. L. Sundararaman, association president, presided over the meeting in the presence of vice presidents S. Sekar and T. Sivaiah. V. Yoganand, secretary, welcomed the guests.

S. R. Raja, MLA for Tambaram Constituency, was the chief guest.

In his address, the politician praised the association for its services in the last 35 years.

He said that the State Government has issued a GO for the construction of an underground drainage system in Chitlapakkam and the adjoining Sembakkam region.

The drinking water supply from the Nemmeli water desalination plant will commence soon for the region, and efforts are being made to allocate further ₹ 8 crores for the completion of pending work in Chitlapakkam, the MLA said.

Senior member and auditor R. Ravindran sponsored the merit awards this year for the wards of members who secured the top three positions in classes X and XII public examinations held in 2024 and 2025.

T. D. Babu, trustee, Nizhal, a trust to promote concern for trees in the city, participated as a special invitee.

He called upon the residents to



Children who performed Bhagwan 'Murugan' Kavadi dance song and winners of other events.

plant more saplings and urged them to be careful not to allow felling of trees without permission.

C. Rajendran, former MP, Chennai (South), was the guest of honour. He appreciated the Association members for unitedly running the forum for more than three decades and recalled how various issues of the Association were solved, especially the stoppage of sale of water from a public well more than 30 years ago; and fund allocation for the restoration of Chitlapakkam Lake.

He distributed the 'Navarathiri Kolu' prizes to the winners.

C. Jagan, member of Ward 43, Tambaram City Municipal Corporation, listed the works completed till date and those in the pipeline.

R. Mohan, former president of Chitlapakkam Selection Grade Town Panchayat, also participated.

A host of colourful cultural programmes including Bharathanatyam, drama, and group song by the women members of Muthulakshmi Nagar Magalir Mandram, slokas and Thirukural recitation by children, and Bhagwan 'Murugan' Kavadi dance song by the children, were a huge hit among the audience. Sports prizes and kolam prizes were also awarded to the winners.

R. M. Easwaran, treasurer, proposed the vote of thanks.

Text: T.S. Atul Swaminathan

'Take a U-turn on the opposite lane'



T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Residents of Chitlapakkam, Hasthinapuram and Sembakkam, please take note. The next time you travel to Tambaram Sanatorium railway station, remember to take a U-turn on the opposite lane. Sounds ridiculous, but this is the best way to avoid accidents.

Diagonally opposite the station, there is a U-turn for motorists heading to Chitlapakkam and the aforementioned regions after dropping off their family members and friends at the station. "But this area is used as a parking lot by two-

wheeler riders, train commuters," says A. Sampath, a commuter and a long-time resident of Chitlapakkam.

As a result, motorists must take the next U-turn area. The median wall below the regional flyover and grade separator obstructs motorists' view from Tambaram (East).

Motorists have requested the Railway Protection Force to remove the vehicles in the area.

"Vehicle users have to literally come to the other lane, see the traffic and take a U-turn."

Moreover, there is a speed breaker on the lane towards Chitlapakkam on Chitlapakkam Second

Main Road. The risk of accidents is higher for those taking a U-turn.

Recently, a car driver took a U-turn close to a young two-wheeler rider, who luckily swerved left.

The same situation prevails on the lane towards Tambaram (East). The same applies to pedestrians, too. The first U-turn (parking area) is located along the lane towards Chitlapakkam.

If motorists from Chitlapakkam and East Tambaram drive left, then there is no problem for those taking a U-turn from Chitlapakkam or for those making a left turn from the station to head to East Tambaram.

Watch out for this 'coiled snake' in Pallikaranai



On a section of the 200-Foot Radial Road between Pallavaram and Thoraipakkam, near Ram Nagar, Pallikaranai, cable wires are lying on the service lane, posing a risk to pedestrians and motorcyclists. The road leading to Ram Nagar and the service lane have been divided. PHOTO AND TEXT: R. RAVINDRAN.

Promoting a rare category of *student volunteers*

With the Board exam season having begun, the need to create a bank of scribes is again being keenly felt



A student appearing for an exam with the help of a scribe. Image used for representational purpose only. PHOTO: PERIASAMY M

LIFY THOMAS

Sharon Rachel Aby's experience of appearing for Class X CBSE Board examinations last year was largely stress-free for two reasons. One, she is academically bright; and two, her school found a junior who was ready to scribe for her in all the six subjects she was taking exams in.

Sharon has Spinal Muscular Atrophy, a rare degenerative disease that restricts hand movement, which means she debilitatingly slow-paced in her writing speed. At Spartan Exclusive School in Mogappair where she studied, she found Akshith of Class IX to scribe for her, and ensured they both had two to three sessions prior to the examinations to understand each other. Sharon scored 92.2% with a centum in French.

For some, finding a scribe can be a straightforward process, but for many students with disabilities

it is a stressful experience, often one that causes them to depend on NGOs and personal networks.

School boards such as Indian Certificate of Secondary Education and Central Board of Secondary Education insist that the candidate can use their discretion in either opting for their own scribe/ reader or requesting the examination centre to provide one. They also insist that the qualification of the scribe be one step below the qualification of the candidate taking the examination.

The rules are different in the School Education Department of Tamil Nadu. Government school teachers are selected by the District Education Office to volunteer as scribes for Class X and XII Board examinations. Earlier, it had planned to appoint interested BED students and Illam Thedi Kalvi volunteers, but that GO was dropped on February 19 after many disability groups objected to limited time in taking up this exercise.

In many cases, candidates who

are homeschooled or writing exams through the National Institute of Open Schooling (NIOS) have to fend for themselves when it comes to finding a scribe.

E.G. Manikandan, a senior special educator with more than 17 years of experience, helps students with NIOS registration including arranging for scribes. He reaches out to private schools well in advance to help identify student volunteers who then have to go through a scribbling orientation exercise. He says NIOS allows parents and close relatives to act as scribes provided

they are registered and meet certain criteria.

"But the challenge is when the parents are not educated and one has to find a suitable volunteer for scribbling," he says, adding that a CBSE school in Mylapore sent him five students last year to scribe.

Having a pool of scribes who can work with students with varying disabilities, including communication-related problems, will go a long way in creating a more empathetic society and it is within the school system that this can be effectively nurtured.

Inclusive schools

"Finding a scribe in an inclusive set-up is easy, and most schools where we work play an important role in promoting inclusion. For instance, at Little Flower School in Kundrathur, announcement is made during the assembly inviting children to volunteer as scribes. They also give certificates to encourage such students," says Kalpana Kumar, founder, Kare Therapy

Centre.

For students applying to study abroad, she says, mention of any volunteering stint as a scribe or efforts to promote inclusion is a bonus and many schools they work with push this agenda to their students, says Kalpana.

A pool of scribes

For many years now, V. Sivaraman, an associate professor at Presidency College, has been asking the office of the Commissioner for Persons with Disabilities to initiate the creation of a common portal for scribes and students. As most colleges have examinations at the same time, depending on students as volunteer-scribes is not always a reliable option. Sometimes, a volunteer would not want to come every day. Though there are many volunteer groups helping find scribes, the professor thinks a portal from the government that lists the needs of the visually challenged and availability of volunteers would be more sustainable.

Exam schedule

ISC: February 12 - April 6
ICSE: February 17 - March 30
CBSE: February 17 - March 11
CBSE: Class XII - February 17 to April 10
SSLC - March 3 - March 27
Class XII - March 2 - March 26

Ferruginous Pochard sighted near Chennai

A lone Ferruginous Pochard was found among a flock of Common Pochards at Amoor lake near Sirudavoor

PRINCE FREDERICK

A sleepy town can be thrust into the limelight when a motorcade of VIPs roll into it. On the trail of these hallowed wheels, might roll wheels of a lesser god. These are the star-struck seeking a glimpse of the glitterati, the shimmering specks of their stardust flying about in the air. Sometimes, just sometimes, a lone VVIP would have slipped in unnoticed among the motorcade, their identity coming to light only when the motorcade screeches to its final halt at the town.

This scenario is playing out at Amoor lake off Tirupo-



rur-Thirukazhukundram Road. Just a couple of kilometres from Sirudavoor lake, Amoor lake became a destination of choice for birders over the last couple of weeks. The VIPs that have been pulling in wheels from Chennai are a sizeable flock of Common Pochards, a rarity in these parts. The lone VVIP that has heightened the level of interest in this waterbody is a lone Ferruginous Duck

(also known as Ferruginous Pochard) that has tagged along with the flock of Common Pochards. A Ferruginous Pochard is more than a rarity anywhere near Chennai, let alone within it.

On February 14, which is Valentine's Day (in case you are a Flintstone unfamiliar with the ways of the modern world), three birders, Sundarav Palanivel, Sivakumar Shanmugasundaram and Sa-

ravana Manian spotted a female Ferruginous Pochard when they were training their cameras with those incredibly elongated lenses on the flock of Common Pochards. They did not conclude the odd one out was a Ferruginous Pochard straightaway. They posted images of the different-looking duck in bird identification forums, a firm word was out that the bird in question was indeed a Ferruginous Pochard. The record was also up on eBird.

Where the Common Pochard (*Aythya ferina*) and the Ferruginous Pochard (*Aythya nyroca*) are concerned, the females can get mixed up in a birder's head, the female of one species being mistaken for the female of the other. This confusion crops up often as the Common Pochards and the Ferruginous Pochards are both diving ducks that are hugely affable to-

wards each other, hanging out together even when they have flown to their winter destination. And they are also known to take this friendship sometimes to a different level, in other words, ending up as more-than-just-friends. And that takes you to a whole new category called Ferruginous Pochard (Hybrid).

When the Pochard literates in these bird identification groups were peering at the images of the lone Ferruginous Pochard from Amoor lake, they had to consider the possibility of it being a hybrid. That possibility was ruled out without an iota of lingering doubt. The verdict is: Ferruginous Pochard female. And that makes it the second time that this species has been sighted in the Chennai Metropolitan Area; the earlier sighting had happened at the Pallikaranai marsh in 2023, that record is also up on eBird.



Two Common Pochards and (above) a Ferruginous Pochard at Amoor lake on February 14. PHOTOS: SARAVANA MANIAN AND SUNDARAVEL PALANIVEL

Envisioning a future-ready roadmap for Chennai

Citizen-driven insights took centre stage at the Super Chennai Conclave 2026; a series of panel discussions marked the event

The first Super Chennai Conclave 2026 brought together policymakers, industry leaders, entrepreneurs and urban visionaries to translate citizen-driven ideas into an actionable roadmap to strengthen infrastructure, safeguard the coastline, and drive inclusive urban transformation.

Speaking at the inaugural address, Dr. J. Radhakrishnan, Additional Chief Secretary to Government of Tamil Nadu; Chairman and Managing director - TANGEDCO, said: "Sustainability must guide how we design transport, strengthen public health and create economic opportunity. Chennai must lead not by comparison, but by competing confidently on the global stage. That requires alignment between government, private enterprise and citizens.



Dr. J. Radhakrishnan (second from left) with other dignitaries at the inauguration of the conclave.

When we move together, collective aspiration becomes measurable progress – and that is how we build a benchmark coastal capital

for the future."

Ranjeeth Rathod, Managing Director, Super Chennai, said, "The conclave represents the transition

from consultation to implementation. Over the past several months, we have engaged with citizens and domain experts to shape a framework that reflects shared priorities for the city's growth. The discussions here reaffirmed the alignment between policy leadership and industry stakeholders. The focus now is on structured follow-through so that the recommendations translate into measurable progress for Chennai."

T R B Rajaa, Minister for Industries, Investment Promotion and Commerce, Government of Tamil Nadu, took part in the conclave. The event saw powerful participation from leaders across sectors, including Arun Vasu, Managing Director, TT Group; Ashwini Asokan, Founder & CEO, Vue.ai (Mad Street Den Inc.); Hari Ganapathy, Co-Founder, Pickyourtrail; Mohamed Ali, President, CREDAI Chennai; Ramkumar Ramamoorthy, Co-Founder & Partner, Catalincs

Partners; Raj Cherubal, Executive Director, Chennai Smart City Limited; Sandeep Nanduri, Managing Director, TIDCO; Soundarya Rajesh, Managing Director, Avtar Group; Sivarajah Ramanathan, Mission Director & CEO, Startup TN; Vikram Cotah, CEO, GRT Hotels; and Vishesh Rajaram, Co-Founder & Managing Partner, Speciale Invest; and filmmaker Gautham Vasudev Menon.

The day saw discussions centered on key pillars critical to Chennai's transformation – investment and industry growth, urban infrastructure, tourism, technology and innovation, entrepreneurship, sustainability, and inclusive development. The conclave witnessed the participation of over 200 delegates, including policymakers, industry leaders, entrepreneurs, journalists and civic stakeholders, reflecting strong cross-sector commitment to shaping the city's future.

Two-day online training course on Generative AI

The Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute, a Department of MSME - Tamil Nadu, is conducting an online training programme on Generative AI from on February 27 and 28. Time: From 6 p.m. to 8 p.m.

According to a press release, the session will cover fundamentals of AI, Machine Learning, Deep Learning, and Generative

AI, along with hands-on exposure to Large Language Models. The training will also focus on integrating AI with PDFs, databases, APIs, and tools.

Participants will learn prompt engineering techniques for real-world engineering use, building AI chatbots, and designing enterprise-level AI systems using Model Context Protocol (MCP).

Special emphasis will be given to AI-assisted coding using modern AI IDEs, debugging, testing, refactoring code with AI, and developing end-to-end AI applications and projects. The programme will also address AI ethics, emerging trends, and career opportunities in the AI domain.

Registration fee is ₹1000. For details, call 9962596111.

Keep your dry waste ready: ROKA drive coming soon

The collection is happening on February 28 and March 1 at various venues across Chennai

ROKA is organising a 12th dry waste collection drive on February 28 and March 1 (open from 9 a.m. to 4 p.m. on both days). For the two-day drive, ROKA is with SPRECO as its recycling partner

According to a press release, Mangayarkarasi Magalir Mandram in Sastri nagar, Adyar has offered its space for the collection drive without any charges.

The items to be collected are: E-waste; clothes (Usable and unusable; in clean and dry condition only); unbroken glass bottles; toys/ stationery; paper, cardboards and magazines; empty tablet strips; thermocol; metals; footwear; plastic (hard and soft/ MLP plastics). The release notes that for the items to be collected, they need to be clean and dry.

The venues for the collection drive are as follows:

Mangayarkarasi Magalir Mandram, Sastri Nagar, Adyar; Apex Club, Velachery; Public



Gym, Sivagamipuram, Thiruvannmiyur; Greater Chennai Corporation park, Dhandayudhapani Nagar, Kotturpuram; Women's India Association, Greenways Road; and New Prince Matriculation Higher Secondary School, Adambakkam (only on Sunday 10 a.m. to 3 p.m.)

Climate action is about conscious consumption and disposal. Those who want to sign up as a volunteer for the drive can call 8667499135.

Temporary changes in train operations

Due to ongoing redevelopment works at Chennai Egmore railway station, the suburban trains scheduled to operate on platforms 10 and 11 (suburban platforms) will run on platforms 5 and 6 till April 5.

During this period, all EMU trains from Chennai Beach to Tambaram, Chengalpattu, Kanchipuram, and Arakkonam will run on platform 6

In return, all EMUs to Chennai Beach will run on platform 5.

During the block period, all existing suburban train services on the Chennai Beach -Tambaram/Chengalpattu/Arakkonam section will be cancelled and operated with revised train schedules.

Chennai Beach - Tambaram: 3.30, 8.05, 8.30, 8.45, 9.05, 10, 10.40, 11, 11.15, and 11.45 a.m, 12 noon, 1.20, 2.30, 3.35, 6, 9.05, 11, 11.25, and 11.50 p.m., and 12.05 a.m.

Chennai Beach - Chengalpattu: 3.45, 4, 4.20, 4.40, 5.20, 5.35, 6.15, 6.40, 6.55, 9.20, 9.45, 10.30, and 11.30 a.m, 12.20, 12.40, 1.45, 2.10, 3.10, 4.05,

4.25, 5, 5.15, 5.30, 5.45, 6.25, 7.05, 7.40, 8.15, 8.30, 8.45, 9.25, 9.45, 10.10, and 10.35.

Chennai Beach - Kanchipuram: 5 a.m. and 7.20 p.m.

Chennai Beach - Thirumal-

pur: 7.05 a.m., 2.50, and 8 p.m.

Chennai Beach - Arakkonam: 1, 6.15, and 6.50 p.m.

Tambaram - Chennai Beach: 3.30, 3.50, 4.10, 4.30, 5.10, 6.10, 9.45 and 10.30 a.m, 12.30, 1.35, 2.15, 3.30, 4.10, 4.25, 5.30, 6.40 p.m., and 12.15 a.m.

For complete details, log on to <https://x.com/DrMChennai>

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An 'import' from Amsterdam to Chennai

The field sport You.Fo is regularly played by teachers at American International School in Taramani



A game of You.Fo at American International School; and (below) Cyril Veronis.

LIFFY THOMAS

A ring-throwing stick-and-catch field sport, born thousands of miles away in Netherlands as late as 2012 and still obscure, is being played by the teachers at American International School in Taramani. And now students of a city college are at it. Students of Sri Kanyaka Parameswari Arts and Science College for Women got introduced to the new sport recently. You.Fo, as the sport is called, is a mixed-gender, non-contact sport played by throwing an aerodynamic ring with specially designed sticks. Combining the features of lacrosse and ultimate frisbee, the sport can be played on the beach sands, playground or any open space measuring 10 by 30 metres.

Cyril Veronis, media and production specialist at American International School, is the ambassador of this sport in Chennai. He got fascinated with this innovative sport. "Most Wednesdays, we teachers would play this sport that was introduced to us by Giovanni Bello, former aquatics director, who had picked it up from the founders directly," says Cyril.

The fitness enthusiast who plays soccer and is regular with every marathon loved You.Fo for the adrenaline rush it brought.

"Something struck me about this sport. May be the speed as I have taken part in more than 50 marathons and cycling events so far and the 10-minute format was easy and fun," says Cyril who is in his late 20s.

He began researching and developed a keen interest in the game, following which Giovan-

ni connected him to the founders. Today, Cyril is playing the role of ambassador and India lead to promote the sport.

"Curious how the game is played competitively, I enrolled for the World Cup last year under the mixed nationality team. This time, the World Cup is scheduled to be held in China in July 2026 and I am keen that India take part in it. The best part is that the sport can be played with a minimum team size of three and multiple teams can represent a country," says Cyril, who studied mechanical engineering before stints in information technology and graphic designing.

In January, he conducted a boot camp along with Pace & Blaze running club at Ampa Skywalk to promote the sport. "My focus is in targetting schools and colleges as this sport was developed in co-creation with PE teachers and students, so that we can have multiple teams by the time this sport becomes a part of the Olympics," he says.

The equipment including the ring and the sticks are manufactured in India and Cyril is working to see how these kits can be made more affordable for all.

As when frisbee was in its early years, You.Fo needs sponsors and above all a team that will compete in the real spirit of the sport.

Until then Cyril is happy to be invited to other institutions to introduce the game and its techniques and find like-minded students keen on taking up the sport. "It is a growing game and the organisers have been tweaking it to make it more acceptable for all age groups," says Cyril, a resident of Choolaimedu.

To know more about the sport, visit Instagram page youfoindiaofficial or call 9566093802



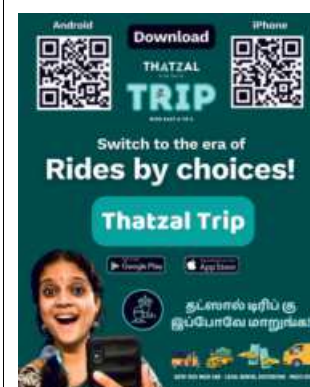
Surya wins two medals



E. Surya Aaditya, a student of SRM Institute of Science and Technology in Kattankulathur, represented Tamil Nadu and won two medals in the Senior National equestrian championships held in New Delhi recently. He was part of the State team that won gold in team event and silver in showjumping. A total of 120 participants competed in the championship.

Rich medal haul for Boccia players from TN

First things first. Boccia is a precision ball sport, the term derived from the Latin word for "boss". It is played by athletes with severe physical disabilities. Recently in Ahmedabad, Boccia Sports Federation of India organised the 10th Senior National Championship in which the Tamil Nadu team consisting of 15 Boccia players bagged four medals under different categories: Individual Match: S. Dinesh Kumar – silver medal under BC-1 male individual category; M. Mahalakshmi – gold under BC-2 female individual category; and M. Anusuya – bronze under BC-3 female individual category



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